

Razorpay Spotlight: Turn a Merchant's Offering into a Bookable, Paid Slot

Track 1: Razorpay in Your Pocket | Full Stack Builder | Nikhil Ramesh

1. Merchant and job to be done

Target merchant: Solo coaches, tutors, instructors and small event hosts who sell a finite number of time slots or seats through Instagram and WhatsApp. They typically operate from a phone and collect payments through UPI.

Job: When a prospect finds me on Instagram or WhatsApp, send one link where they can understand the offering, choose an open slot, pay by UPI, and have the booking recorded automatically.

2. Current Journey & Problem

Step	How it works today	Problem
1. Advertise	Basic creative or post shared on WhatsApp.	Posts cannot take bookings; every lead becomes a chat.
2. Inform	Event flow and logistics on WhatsApp, or an Unbounce page for larger hosts.	Details repeated lead by lead; pages take setup effort and are not linked to availability or payment.
3. Book	Customer picks a slot by availability and location; host confirms in chat.	Back-and-forth delays the sale; nothing holds the slot, so double booking is possible.
4. Pay	Razorpay Payment Page or Link, or personal UPI ID.	No slot attached to payment; buyers hesitate to pay a personal ID; redirects break UPI in in-app browsers.
5. Attend	Host sends tickets and reminders and handles cancellations and rescheduling.	Manual reconciliation across different data sources and coordination with customers.

3. Why Razorpay and why mobile

Why Razorpay: No Razorpay product sells a slot, so most of these merchants collect payments on a personal UPI ID (using a register or website for slot mapping), and those on Razorpay use it only for the payment step.

Spotlight makes the slot the unit of sale, with payment locking inventory and updating the roster. That brings UPI-only merchants onto Razorpay and moves existing ones from one step to the whole booking, without Razorpay becoming a discovery or advertising marketplace.

Why mobile: The merchant's schedule, customer chats, photos and payments already live on the phone, and setup has to happen at the court, studio or venue, not at a desktop.

4. Solution: publish a bookable offering in under two minutes (post onboarding / KYC)

1. Describe · ~45s	Merchant speaks or types the offer and adds 2–3 photos. Example: "Tennis at KSLTA, Mon–Fri 6–9 AM, 1-hour slots, ₹600, max 2 per slot, full refund with 12 hours' notice."
2. Confirm · ~30s	AI parses schedule, duration, price, capacity and cancellation rules. It flags missing or conflicting values and shows an editable summary. Nothing publishes without approval.
3. Share · ~15s	Spotlight creates a mobile booking page with merchant profile, photos, Razorpay-verified trust signals, live slots and refund terms. Merchant shares it on Instagram or WhatsApp.
4. Customer books	Customer selects a slot and pays by UPI. Inventory locks on payment; confirmation includes the booking details, map pin and calendar invite. No app install.
5. Run the day	A Today roster shows who has booked and paid, with nothing to reconcile. Customers cancel from their booking link; within policy, Razorpay refunds them and the slot goes back on sale.

5. Product choices and deliberate exclusions

Build	Why
Voice/text → fixed mobile template	Gets a merchant from idea to shareable page in under two minutes.
Recurring and one-time slot inventory	Covers both weekly sessions and finite-seat events; payment locks inventory.
Razorpay trust signals	Verified business, automatic refunds and a track record from Razorpay data (events hosted, refund rate) increases trust with a first-time customer.
Today roster	Closes the loop from payment to the merchant's actual operating workflow.

Out of scope: drag-and-drop page builder, client-facing app, discovery marketplace, CRM, memberships and packages, and reminders, which can later build on Razorpay Engage's WhatsApp and SMS channels.

6. Success metrics

Adoption	<i>First-link publish rate:</i> % of merchants who start setup and publish in the same session.
Experience	<i>Time to publish:</i> app open → live link copied, measured for first page and repeat edits.
Impact	<i>Page-to-payment conversion</i> versus the merchant's current multi-redirect funnel.
Retention	<i>Repeat publishing:</i> recurring hosts refresh slots in weeks 4 and 6; one-time hosts publish a second event within 45 days.
Guardrail	<i>Refunds and disputes</i> per 100 bookings to ensure badge conveys trust to customer and provides value to the merchant. Merchants with poor performance are provided improvement tips.